

Kamal Joshi

Staff Software Engineer | Go | Distributed Systems | AWS | API Infrastructure

Austin, TX | Remote | Open to relocation for the right opportunity

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Staff-level software engineer with deep experience building highly available, high-throughput distributed systems and API platforms at scale. Proven track record of end-to-end production ownership — from architecture and API design through incident leadership and systemic reliability improvements. Spent two years as a daily power user of GitHub Copilot and Claude Code across the full SDLC; I don't just use AI tools, I've gotten genuinely effective at directing them to produce safe, testable, readable code while owning the design, quality bar, and business outcome. Uniquely positioned to build infrastructure for the product I've already internalized as an engineer.

CORE STRENGTHS

- **Distributed systems and platform engineering:** Go, Java, REST, gRPC, JSON/HTTP APIs, microservices, event-driven systems, high-throughput async pipelines, webhooks, CloudEvents
- **Reliability and production ownership:** incident leadership, DLQ recovery, multi-region HA rollouts, sovereign/GovCloud environments, rate-limit governance, deployment validation, on-call ownership
- **Cloud and infrastructure:** AWS (ECS, EKS, S3, SQS/SNS, DynamoDB, Secrets Manager), Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, CI/CD (Jenkins)
- **API design and security:** API gateways (Kong), OAuth 2.0, OIDC, API key management, secure coding, authorization services, third-party integrations
- **Technical leadership:** architecture briefs, cross-team design reviews, mentoring early-in-career engineers, pragmatic architecture, roadmap shaping
- **AI-assisted SDLC:** daily use of GitHub Copilot, Claude Code, and Codex across implementation, IaC, testing, debugging, code review, and design exploration; working familiarity with agentic tool patterns (LLM + memory + tool use); pioneered team-wide GitHub Copilot adoption ahead of broader Cisco AI initiatives

EXPERIENCE

Cisco

Software Engineering Technical Leader

November 2025 - Present | Austin, TX

- Owned and operated highly available backend systems including **API Gateway, Authorization Service, and Third-Party Integrations Service** — spanning design, implementation, production support, and cross-team coordination.
- **Prevented security-event message loss** during a production webhook incident by identifying a **300k+ message DLQ backlog**, quantifying impact across **15 orgs**, and redriving messages successfully within **5-10 minutes** — full incident ownership from detection to resolution.
- Drove integrations-svc production readiness across **sovereign and multi-region environments** by decomposing a high-risk Terraform rollout into staged changes across ECR, Secrets Manager, DynamoDB streams, SNS, and service config, validating **HA behavior across two regions**.
- **Diagnosed and fixed a critical integration issue live during a prospective customer evaluation**, contributing directly to the **customer's purchase decision**.
- Resolved a customer-scale onboarding failure by tracing **250+ appliance registration requests** through API key auth and rate-limit behavior, driving durable fixes around retry/backoff, token reuse, and service ownership.
- Drove cross-service **API design** for customer-selected Splunk and CloudEvents webhook formats across alerts, security events, integrations, and notifications services.
- Led design and delivery of real-time push security events capability using the open **CloudEvents** standard, delivering **alpha on schedule (Nov 2025)** with a team of three engineers.

Senior Software Engineer

January 2021 - November 2025 | Austin, TX

- Advanced platform capabilities across API gateway, authorization, integrations, and event-delivery domains using **Go, AWS, Terraform**, and event-driven architecture.
- Built auth-tools, an internal authorization library adopted across multiple platform services, simplifying OAuth/policy enforcement integration for downstream teams.
- Integrated **AI tooling (GitHub Copilot, Claude Code, Codex)** into daily engineering workflow across the full SDLC; pioneered team-wide Copilot adoption ahead of broader Cisco AI initiatives.
- Mentored early-in-career engineers through code review, design feedback, and hands-on guidance, growing the team's Go and platform engineering capabilities.

Randstad Technologies US at Cisco

Senior Software Developer

March 2015 - January 2021 | Dublin, OH

- Designed and implemented **Go-based gRPC and JSON/HTTP APIs** for a cloud-native data ingestion platform.
- Built OIDC/OAuth 2.0 authentication and authorization flows integrated across frontend and backend layers.
- Designed and implemented a type-assisted search feature for an **Active Threat Analytics** dashboard, reducing analyst friction for threat-hunting queries.
- Reduced **100+ OWASP-reported security warnings to zero** through secure coding, browser security headers, input sanitization, and server-side validation.

Earlier Engineering Experience

Cognizant, Oracle, Collabera | January 2007 - February 2015

- Delivered backend services and integrations across financial services, healthcare, insurance, and enterprise domains.
- Built foundation in Java, REST APIs, service integrations, and maintainable engineering practices.

CERTIFICATIONS

- AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate
- AWS Certified Developer - Associate
- MongoDB Certified Java Developer M101J
- Google Cloud Platform Essentials

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Engineering, Information Technology
Dharmsinh Desai University